THE MARATHAS, SHIVAJI & AURANGZEB'S DECCAN; JAGIRDARI CRISIS

WESTERN DECCAN: TERRAIN BECOMES → CHRONOLOGY FROM THE 1640S → PURANDAR, AGRA AND RECOVERY → CORONATION AND THE LANGUAGE → ASHTAPRADHAN: EIGHT OFFICES, NOT → CHAUTH AND SARDESHMUKHI ARE

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

● PRIMARY CORE FLOW ● SUBORDINATE EXTRA ● APPROVAL / REVIEW

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g3 and all prior artifacts unchanged

00

STAGE 00

WESTERN DECCAN: TERRAIN BECOMES A FORT NETWORK

WESTERN DECCAN · TERRAIN BECOMES A FORT NETWORK · SAHYADRI RIDGE · HEIGHT, NARROW PASSES AND MONSOON FRICTION · MAVAL VALLEYS · RECRUITS, GRAIN, LOCAL INTELLIGENCE AND SHORT MOVEMENT · KONKAN COAST · CREEKS, CUSTOMS, PORTS AND ACCESS TO MARITIME RIVALS

SAHYADRI RIDGE → height, narrow passes and monsoon friction

MAVAL VALLEYS → recruits, grain, local intelligence and short movement → KONKAN COAST → creeks, customs, ports and access to maritime rivals → FORT NODE → garrison + store + signal + refuge + route surveillance

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY
- SAHYADRI RIDGE → height, narrow passes and monsoon friction
- MAVAL VALLEYS → recruits, grain, local intelligence and short movement
- KONKAN COAST → creeks, customs, ports and access to maritime rivals

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM
- FORT NODE → garrison + store + signal + refuge + route surveillance
- NETWORK EFFECT → inland plateau, passes and coast support one another
- LIMIT → geography enables choices; organisation converts it into power.

DEBATE / LEGACY
- MUST REMEMBER: Shivaji's coronation (1674), fort network, revenue claims and military mobility formed a negotiated regional polity.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: MUST REMEMBER: Shivaji's coronation (1674), fort network, revenue claims and military mobility formed a negotiated regional polity.

01

STAGE 01

CHRONOLOGY FROM THE 1640S TO 1707

CHRONOLOGY FROM THE 1640S TO 1707 · TORNA, MURUMBDEV-RAJGAD AND KONDANA BUILD A POONA-MAVAL BASE · POONA RAID · AGRA RUPTURE · TERRITORIAL RECOVERY · RAIGAD CORONATION · SHIVAJI DIES · SAMBHAJI EXECUTED

1640s → Torna, Murumbdev-Rajgad and Kondana build a Poona-Maval base → 1656 → Javli → 1659 → Pratapgad → 1663 → Poona raid → 1664 → Surat

CHRONOLOGY / PHASE
- 1640s → Torna, Murumbdev-Rajgad and Kondana build a Poona-Maval base
- 1656 → Javli
- 1659 → Pratapgad
- 1663 → Poona raid
- 1664 → Surat

MATERIAL / INSTITUTION
- 1665 → Purandar
- 1666 → Agra rupture
- 1670 → territorial recovery
- 1674 → Raigad coronation
- 1680 → Shivaji dies

IMPACT / LIMIT
- 1689 → Sambhaji executed
- Rajaram shifts resistance toward Jinji
- 1700 → Tarabai's regency
- 1707 → Aurangzeb dies with war unresolved.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: 1700 → Tarabai's regency | 1707 → Aurangzeb dies with war unresolved.

02

STAGE 02

PURANDAR, AGRA AND RECOVERY

PURANDAR, AGRA AND RECOVERY · MUGHAL PRESSURE · JAI SINGH COMBINES SIEGE, DIPLOMACY AND BIJAPUR STRATEGY · PURANDAR 1665 · 23 FORTS CEDED, 12 RETAINED; SAMBHAJI RECEIVES MANSAB 5000 · INCORPORATION TEST · SERVICE AND A RETAINED BASE COEXIST UNEASILY · AGRA 1666

MUGHAL PRESSURE → Jai Singh combines siege, diplomacy and Bijapur strategy → PURANDAR 1665 → 23 forts ceded, 12 retained; Sambhaji receives mansab 5000 → INCORPORATION TEST → service and a retained base coexist uneasily → AGRA 1666 → rank dispute, confinement and escape destroy political trust → RECOVERY FROM 1670 → forts and initiative return; surrender was not final

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY
- MUGHAL PRESSURE → Jai Singh combines siege, diplomacy and Bijapur strategy
- PURANDAR 1665 → 23 forts ceded, 12 retained; Sambhaji receives mansab 5000

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM
- INCORPORATION TEST → service and a retained base coexist uneasily
- AGRA 1666 → rank dispute, confinement and escape destroy political trust

DEBATE / LEGACY
- RECOVERY FROM 1670 → forts and initiative return; surrender was not final
- SOURCE RULE → escape is secure; basket details remain a source version.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: SOURCE RULE → escape is secure; basket details remain a source version.

03

STAGE 03

CORONATION AND THE LANGUAGE OF SOVEREIGNTY

CORONATION AND THE LANGUAGE OF SOVEREIGNTY · POWER ALREADY BUILT · FORTS, REVENUE, COMMAND AND NEGOTIATED AUTHORITY · RAIGAD 1674 · PUBLIC CLAIM TO CHHATRAPATI SOVEREIGNTY · GAGA BHATTA · KSHATRIYA GENEALOGY ADDRESSES CONTESTED STATUS · RITUAL EFFECT

POWER ALREADY BUILT → forts, revenue, command and negotiated authority

RAIGAD 1674 → public claim to chhatrapati sovereignty → GAGA BHATTA → Kshatriya genealogy addresses contested status → RITUAL EFFECT → ruler stands above chiefs in a legible royal idiom

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY
- POWER ALREADY BUILT → forts, revenue, command and negotiated authority
- RAIGAD 1674 → public claim to chhatrapati sovereignty

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM
- GAGA BHATTA → Kshatriya genealogy addresses contested status
- RITUAL EFFECT → ruler stands above chiefs in a legible royal idiom

DEBATE / LEGACY
- POLITICAL EFFECT → household, territory and administration gain one centre
- LIMIT → coronation crowned state-building; it did not create capacity alone.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: LIMIT → coronation crowned state-building; it did not create capacity alone.

04

STAGE 04

ASHTAPRADHAN: EIGHT OFFICES, NOT A CABINET

EIGHT OFFICES, NOT A CABINET · GENERAL COORDINATION · RECORDS AND INTELLIGENCE · EXTERNAL AFFAIRS · RELIGIOUS GRANTS AND DUTIES · CONTROL PRINCIPLE · EACH OFFICE ANSWERS TO THE RULER · NO COLLECTIVE RESPONSIBILITY, PARLIAMENTARY CABINET OR LATER PESHWA RULE.

PESHWA → general coordination

AMATYA / MAZUMDAR → finance → SACHIV → correspondence → MANTRI / WAQIA-NAVIS → records and intelligence

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY
- PESHWA → general coordination
- AMATYA / MAZUMDAR → finance
- SACHIV → correspondence
- MANTRI / WAQIA-NAVIS → records and intelligence

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM
- SENAPATI / SAR-I-NAUBAT → military
- SUMANT / DABIR → external affairs
- NYAYADHISH → justice
- PANDITRAO → religious grants and duties

DEBATE / LEGACY
- CONTROL PRINCIPLE → each office answers to the ruler
- TRAP → no collective responsibility, parliamentary cabinet or later Peshwa rule.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: TRAP → no collective responsibility, parliamentary cabinet or later Peshwa rule.

05

STAGE 05

CHAUTH AND SARDESHMUKHI ARE DISTINCT CLAIMS

CHAUTH AND SARDESHMUKHI ARE DISTINCT CLAIMS · ONE-QUARTER FISCAL CLAIM, OFTEN TIED TO PROTECTION AND RESTRAINT · ADDITIONAL TEN-PERCENT CLAIM IN A SUPERIOR-RIGHT IDIOM · AGENTS BARGAIN, COERCE AND OVERLAP WITH EXISTING REVENUE SYSTEMS · POLITICAL EFFECT · PAYMENT MAY ACKNOWLEDGE POWER WITHOUT SETTLED SOVEREIGNTY · LOCAL EFFECT · PAYER CAN SEEK RELIEF WHILE PARALLEL AUTHORITY BECOMES NORMAL

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY	EVIDENCE / MECHANISM	DEBATE / LEGACY
CHAUTH → one-quarter fiscal claim, often tied to protection and restraint	COLLECTION → agents bargain, coerce and overlap with existing revenue systems	LOCAL EFFECT → payer can seek relief while parallel authority becomes normal
SARDESHMUKHI → additional ten-percent claim in a superior-right idiom	POLITICAL EFFECT → payment may acknowledge power without settled sovereignty	TRAP → neither pure plunder nor automatic lawful title explains every case.

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY
- CHAUTH → one-quarter fiscal claim, often tied to protection and restraint
- SARDESHMUKHI → additional ten-percent claim in a superior-right idiom

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM
- COLLECTION → agents bargain, coerce and overlap with existing revenue systems
- POLITICAL EFFECT → payment may acknowledge power without settled sovereignty

DEBATE / LEGACY
- LOCAL EFFECT → payer can seek relief while parallel authority becomes normal
- TRAP → neither pure plunder nor automatic lawful title explains every case.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: TRAP → neither pure plunder nor automatic lawful title explains every case.

06

STAGE 06

CAVALRY AND GANIMI KAVA

CAVALRY AND GANIMI KAVA · HORSE AND EQUIPMENT ASSOCIATED WITH STATE PROVISION · MAINTAINS HIS OWN HORSE AND EQUIPMENT · GANIMI KAVA · SURPRISE + INTELLIGENCE + SUPPLY ATTACK + SELECTIVE ENGAGEMENT · FORT ANCHOR · STORES, REFUGE, SIGNALS AND ROUTE CONTROL SUSTAIN MOBILITY · LOCAL KNOWLEDGE

BARGIR → horse and equipment associated with state provision → SILHEDAR → maintains his own horse and equipment → GANIMI KAVA → surprise + intelligence + supply attack + selective engagement → FORT ANCHOR → stores, refuge, signals and route control sustain mobility → LOCAL KNOWLEDGE → converts short movement into operational advantage

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY
- BARGIR → horse and equipment associated with state provision
- SILHEDAR → maintains his own horse and equipment

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM
- GANIMI KAVA → surprise + intelligence + supply attack + selective engagement
- FORT ANCHOR → stores, refuge, signals and route control sustain mobility

DEBATE / LEGACY
- LOCAL KNOWLEDGE → converts short movement into operational advantage
- LIMIT → not invincibility, a social census or modern ideological insurgency.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: LIMIT → not invincibility, a social census or modern ideological insurgency.

07

STAGE 07

COAST AND NAVY: CAPABILITY WITH SCALE LIMITS

COAST AND NAVY · CAPABILITY WITH SCALE LIMITS · CREEKS, PORTS, CUSTOMS AND SEA FORTS CONNECT WAR TO · SIDIS OF JANJIRA, PORTUGUESE AND ENGLISH SHAPE NAVAL CHOICES · KOLI, BHANDARI, MUSLIM AND OTHER SAILORS PREVENT A CLOSED · GURAB AND GALIVAT LABELS REQUIRE SOURCE AND CONTEXT · REGIONAL ESCORT, DEFENCE, RAIDING AND COASTAL COMMUNICATION · NOT AN OCEANIC BLUE-WATER NAVY OR A LICENCE TO

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY
- KONKAN → creeks, ports, customs and sea forts connect war to commerce
- RIVALS → Sidis of Janjira, Portuguese and English shape naval choices

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM
- PEOPLE → Koli, Bhandari, Muslim and other sailors prevent a closed identity
- VESSELS → gurab and galivat labels require source and context

DEBATE / LEGACY
- CAPABILITY → regional escort, defence, raiding and coastal communication
- LIMIT → not an oceanic blue-water navy or a licence to invent fleet numbers.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: LIMIT → not an oceanic blue-water navy or a licence to invent fleet numbers.

08

STAGE 08

RESISTANCE AFTER SHIVAJI

RESISTANCE AFTER SHIVAJI · SAMBHAJI 1680-89 · LEADERSHIP UNDER PRESSURE; EXECUTION REMOVES A HEAD · MOVEMENT TO JINJI CREATES STRATEGIC DEPTH BEYOND MAHARASHTRA · STRIKE COMMUNICATIONS AND DISPERSED IMPERIAL FORCES · RAMCHANDRA PANT · ADMINISTRATION AND PATRONAGE SUSTAIN NETWORKS · TARABAI FROM 1700

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY
- SAMBHAJI 1680-89 → leadership under pressure; execution removes a head
- RAJARAM → movement to Jinji creates strategic depth beyond Maharashtra

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM
- SANTAJI / DHANAJI → strike communications and dispersed imperial forces
- RAMCHANDRA PANT / SHANKARAJI → administration and patronage sustain networks

DEBATE / LEGACY
- TARABAI FROM 1700 → regency supplies legitimacy and political coordination
- RESULT → decapitation changes the war into a more decentralised resistance.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: RESULT → decapitation changes the war into a more decentralised resistance.

09

STAGE 09

ANNEXATION REMOVES BUFFERS

ANNEXATION REMOVES BUFFERS · BIJAPUR 1686 + GOLCONDA 1687 · TERRITORY, FORTS AND NOMINAL REVENUE GAINED · BUFFER LOSS · MUGHALS NOW CONFRONT MOBILE MARATHA NETWORKS MORE DIRECTLY · NEW CLAIMANTS · ABSORBED ELITES ADD SERVICE AND JAGIR EXPECTATIONS · NEW COSTS

BIJAPUR 1686 + GOLCONDA 1687 → territory, forts and nominal revenue gained → BUFFER LOSS → Mughals now confront mobile Maratha networks more directly → NEW CLAIMANTS → absorbed elites add service and jagir expectations → NEW COSTS → garrisons, siege trains, supply, policing and collection friction → REALISATION PROBLEM → conquered jama does not guarantee usable hasil

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY
- BIJAPUR 1686 + GOLCONDA 1687 → territory, forts and nominal revenue gained
- BUFFER LOSS → Mughals now confront mobile Maratha networks more directly
- NEW CLAIMANTS → absorbed elites add service and jagir expectations

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM
- NEW COSTS → garrisons, siege trains, supply, policing and collection friction
- REALISATION PROBLEM → conquered jama does not guarantee usable hasil
- VERDICT → annexation enlarged the map while narrowing strategic flexibility.

DEBATE / LEGACY
- CLOSE DISTINCTION: Ashtapradhan was not a modern cabinet; chauth and sardeshmukhi varied by claim, agreement, collection and territory.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → annexation enlarged the map while narrowing strategic flexibility.

10

STAGE 10

JAGIRDARI TERMS AND THE FEEDBACK LOOP

JAGIRDARI TERMS AND THE FEEDBACK LOOP · RANK AND SERVICE CLAIM · TRANSFERABLE REVENUE ASSIGNMENT · ASSESSED CLAIM · REALISED COLLECTION · RESERVE ASSIGNABLE POOL · SHORTAGE OF USABLE ASSIGNMENTS · INFLATED JAMA

MANSAB → rank and service claim

JAGIR → transferable revenue assignment → JAMA → assessed claim → HASIL → realised collection

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY
- MANSAB → rank and service claim
- JAGIR → transferable revenue assignment
- JAMA → assessed claim
- HASIL → realised collection

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM
- PAIBAQI → reserve assignable pool
- BE-JAGIRI → shortage of usable assignments
- WAR / INFLATED JAMA → weak hasil → troop and remount shortfall
- HARDER EXTRACTION → local resistance / private pacts → further disturbance

DEBATE / LEGACY
- RESULT → fiscal, agrarian, administrative and military strain reinforce one another.
- EVIDENCE LIMIT: Deccan war and jagirdari crisis interacted with succession, ecology and regional resistance but do not alone explain decline.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: RESULT → fiscal, agrarian, administrative and military strain reinforce one another.

11

STAGE 11

TOPIC 23 FINAL ANSWER SPINE

TOPIC 23 FINAL ANSWER SPINE · ECOLOGY BECAME POWER THROUGH INSTITUTIONS, NETWORKS AND SOVEREIGNTY · EARLY FORTS · OFFICES + REVENUE + CHAUTH CLAIMS + MOBILE WAR · TARABAI'S DECENTRALISED RESISTANCE · ANNEXATION AND LONG WAR INTENSIFY THE JAGIRDARI FEEDBACK LOOP · REJECT HERO MYTH, NATIONALISM, CABINET ANALOGY AND INSTANT COLLAPSE.

OPEN → ecology became power through institutions, networks and sovereignty → TRACE → early forts → Purandar / Agra → recovery → coronation → EXPLAIN → offices + revenue + chauth claims + mobile war + bounded navy → EXTEND → Sambhaji → Rajaram / Jinji → Tarabai's decentralised resistance → CONNECT → annexation and long war intensify the jagirdari feedback loop

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY
- OPEN → ecology became power through institutions, networks and sovereignty
- TRACE → early forts → Purandar / Agra → recovery → coronation

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM
- EXPLAIN → offices + revenue + chauth claims + mobile war + bounded navy
- EXTEND → Sambhaji → Rajaram / Jinji → Tarabai's decentralised resistance

DEBATE / LEGACY
- CONNECT → annexation and long war intensify the jagirdari feedback loop
- QUALIFY → reject hero myth, nationalism, cabinet analogy and instant collapse.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: QUALIFY → reject hero myth, nationalism, cabinet analogy and instant collapse.

E

EXTRA

SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT · ADVANCED EVIDENCE NOTEBOOK · TWENTY-EIGHT SOURCE-TO-ARGUMENT LABS · EVIDENCE AND ANSWER-WRITING DRILLS · THE MARATHAS, SHIVAJI & AURANGZEB'S DECCAN; JAGIRDARI CRISIS — · 1. SNAPSHOT & CORE IDEA · 2. KEY CLASSIFICATION · 3. STUDY LINKS

OPTIONAL SOURCE DEPTH
- Advanced evidence notebook: twenty-eight source-to-argument labs
- Evidence and answer-writing drills
- The Marathas, Shivaji & Aurangzeb's Deccan; Jagirdari Crisis — ADVANCED
- Mini-timeline

ADVANCED DEBATE
- 1. Snapshot & core idea
- 2. Key classification / data
- 3. Study links
- 4. Must Know Facts (Prelims)

LEGACY / NUANCE
- 5. UPSC Traps
- 6. Current link
- 7. Mains angles
- + Concept — Jagirdari crisis in one line

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.

END OF MASTER CANVAS • poster embeds this exact master • tiled pages are overlapping crops of the same pixels